**INSTRUCTIONAL AREA**
Professional Development

# ACCOUNTING APPLICATIONS SERIES EVENT

## PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

## SOLUTION

- Accurate – Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

## CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

## PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Ascertain employee's role in meeting organizational goals.
2. Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development.
3. Describe the services of professional organizations in accounting.
4. Discuss opportunities for building professional relationships in finance.
5. Identify skills needed to enhance career progression.

**EVENT SITUATION**

You are to assume the role of the accounting manager at SAGE & SALT RESTAURANT GROUP, a company that owns 18 restaurants. A newly hired staff accountant (judge) wants to understand how the job connects to the company's goals.

The chief financial officer (CFO) has set a goal to cut the monthly closing of the books from 12 business days to 7 by the end of next year. Right now, the staff accountant (judge) reconciles the bank accounts for all 18 restaurants by hand, which takes 20 hours each month. The company is buying reconciliation software that will cut that work to 6 hours each month. Staff accountants are paid an average of $35 per hour.

The company also gives each accountant a $1,200 yearly professional development budget that can be used for training, conferences or memberships in professional organizations, such as the state society of CPAs or the Institute of Management Accountants (IMA).

The staff accountant (judge) wants you to:

- Explain how the staff accountant's (judge's) work affects the CFO's goal.
- Calculate the hours and labor dollars the software will save each year.
- Recommend how to use the $1,200 professional development budget.
- Explain what professional organizations in accounting offer their members.
- Explain how to build professional relationships and which skills will help the staff accountant (judge) advance.

You will present the information to the staff accountant (judge) in a meeting at the corporate office. The staff accountant (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking about the role. After you have presented the information and answered the staff accountant's (judge's) questions, the staff accountant (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. If software does part of my job now, should I be worried about my position?
2. What would you need to see from me in my first year to consider me for a senior accountant role?

| | Rate the participant's ability to: | Novice | Developing | Proficient | Exemplary | Judged Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **PERFORMANCE INDICATORS** | | | | | | |
| 1. | Ascertain employee's role in meeting organizational goals. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| 2. | Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| 3. | Describe the services of professional organizations in accounting. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| 4. | Discuss opportunities for building professional relationships in finance. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| 5. | Identify skills needed to enhance career progression. | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6 | 7-8-9 | 10 | |
| **SOLUTION** | | | | | | |
| 6. | **Accurate**<br>Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen. | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| 7. | **Practical**<br>Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context. | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| 8. | **Effective**<br>Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| **CAEREER COMPETANCIES** | | | | | | |
| 9. | **Critical Thinking**<br>Think critically to understand and solve problems | 0-1 | 2-3 | 4-5 | 6 | |
| 10. | **Communication**<br>Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason. | 0-1 | 2-3 | 4-5 | 6 | |
| 11. | **Decision Making**<br>Consider the impacts of decisions. | 0-1 | 2-3 | 4-5 | 6 | |
| **OVERALL IMPRESSIONS** | | | | | | |
| 12. | Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence. | 0-1-2 | 3-4-5 | 6-7 | 8 | |
| | | | | | **TOTAL SCORE** | |

**Answer key**: 14 hours saved per month × 12 months = 168 hours per year. 168 hours × $35 = $5,880 per year.